

Unit 4

Lithosphere: Exogenic Processes



Chapter Outline

4.1 Introduction

4.2 Exogenic Processes

4.3 Weathering

4.4 Mass wasting

4.5 Gradational Processes

4.6 The River

4.7 Glacier

4.8 Ground water (Karst Topography)

4.9 Wind

4.10 Waves (Coast)

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Learning Objectives:

- *Understand how external forces reshape the surface of the earth.*
- *Distinguish between physical weathering and chemical weathering.*
- *Identify the different types of mass wasting and its characteristics.*
- *Distinguish between the actions of various gradational agents.*

At Mahabalipuram, Chennai, the 6 meter high and 5-metre wide rock estimated to weigh over 250 tons is known locally as Krishna's Butter Ball. Its original Tamil name is "Vaanirai Kal" which literally translates to "Stone of The Sky God"

Look at the figure above Krishna's Butter ball inserted on the top and let's discuss:

- What, do you think, made this rock stone to get this shape.
- Guess how many years it might have taken to get such a shape.
- Think about how it is standing balanced.

4.1 Introduction

Let's recall that you have learned in the previous chapter about geomorphic processes - Endogenic processes in detail. Now we deal with the exogenic processes. The forces which act on the earth's exterior are called as exogenic forces or external

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